University of Lahore (UOL)
Lahore school of nursing (LSN)
Assignment: CHN 2
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Section: A

1. Why I Chose This Topic. Why It Matters

I chose Dengue Fever as my topic because it is a major public health problem in Lahore and it is very important for nurses to know about it. Dengue Fever is a disease that can be passed from person to person and it needs to be treated in two ways: by taking care of the patient and by watching out for it in the community.
Lahore has a lot of cases of Dengue Fever during times of the year especially after the monsoon season from August to November. I want to show how the things we learn in nursing school can be used in life to help patients health officials, lab technicians, family members and people in the community.
Knowing about Dengue Fever will help nurses understand the aspects of the disease and develop ways to treat patients that are sensitive to their culture and based on evidence.

2. What the Research Says

According to the World Health Organization in 2023 Dengue Fever is a disease caused by a virus that is carried by mosquitoes of the species Aedes aegypti. Every year there are 390 million cases of Dengue Fever and 96 million of them are serious enough to need attention.
Research shows that the "critical period" of the disease, which is usually days 3-7 is when patients are most likely to have serious problems like hypovolemic shock if they are not treated aggressively.
A study done in the Punjab province by Fatima and others in 2022 found that changes in temperature and precipitation are directly related to the peak season of Dengue Fever transmission. The study also found that 70 percent of the places where mosquitoes breeding are inside households, such as water coolers, flower pots and abandoned tires. This shows that nurses should focus on educating the community about how to prevent Dengue Fever.
Another study done in 2023 by the Pakistan Institute of Medical Sciences found that if patients wait more than three days to get treatment they are 4.5 times more likely to have severe Dengue Fever.

3. Developing the Questionnaire

I created a questionnaire to collect data from five groups of people: patients, lab technicians, public health officials, community members and parents or teachers.
The questions were about how to identify symptoms how long it takes to get a diagnosis what the community is doing to prevent Dengue Fever and what is getting in the way of controlling the environment.

STEP 02: WRITTEN ASSIGNMENT

1. Dengue Fever is a common viral disease in tropical regions and can cause severe illness, especially in Pakistan. During the 2023 monsoon season Lahore had more than 4,500 cases of Dengue Fever. This report talks about the data I collected from five interviews with people. The goal of this report is to look at both the preventive aspects of Dengue Fever in the community and in hospitals.

2. Analyzing the Data and Perspectives

A. The Patient Perspective

The patient said, "I had a high fever, 104°F and my body hurt all over. At first I thought it was the flu. Now I am more careful because I know how serious Dengue Fever can be."
As a nurse I think that patients might wait long to get diagnosed because the symptoms of Dengue Fever are similar to those of the flu. Nurses should teach patients about the differences between Dengue Fever and the flu using charts. It is also important to note that if patients get infected with another type of Dengue Fever they are more likely to have symptoms.

B. The Lab Technition Point of View

The lab technician said, "Many patients wait until they are very weak before they come in for a test. We are telling all patients who have a fever and a rash to get a CBC test right away because we have seen cases where the platelet count is going down."
As a nurse I think that patients should get tested on the day of their symptoms because if they wait too long it can be too late. Nurses in the outpatient department should stress the importance of getting tested. If the platelet count is going down it can be a sign of plasma leakage and nurses need to act to give the patient fluids.

C. The Public Health Official's Perspective

The public health official said, "We are visiting places where mosquitoes might be breeding, like tire workshops and nurseries to get rid of them.. We need the community help to make sure all stagnant water is drained."
As a nurse I think that community health nurses play a role in getting the community involved in preventing Dengue Fever. We can use a "Dengue Home Inspection Checklist" to help households get rid of breeding sites. We should also work with the community to create a map of areas that are at high risk and do weekly inspections.

D. The Resident's Perspective

The resident said, "We try to cover up water containers but sometimes our neighbors houses are empty and they have things like tires and paint boxes that collect rainwater and become breeding sites for mosquitoes."

As a nurse I think that we need to work with the community to identify areas that are at high risk and get rid of breeding sites. We can work with the union council to create a database of problem areas and educate residents about how to use larvicide to kill larvae in permanent water containers.

E. The Teacher/Parent Perspective

The teacher/parent said, "My son told me that there were mosquitoes in his classroom and I am worried. I also read that childhood obesity can make Dengue Fever worse and that is making me more worried."

As a nurse I think that pediatric nurses need to prioritize children who are at high risk. Obesity in children can make Dengue Fever symptoms worse so we need to create "Dengue- zones" in schools. School nurses should do health seminars. Get rid of stagnant water in school grounds.

3. Conclusion and Nursing Recommendations

To prevent Dengue Fever we need to work as a community. Based on the interviews I recommend the following:

- Use a "Dengue Early Warning Card" in outpatient departments to identify patients who are at high risk.
- Do inspections of households in high-risk areas to get rid of breeding sites.
- Work with the community to pass laws that prevent properties from becoming breeding sites.
- Create a "Larva Hunter" program in schools to educate children about how to prevent Dengue Fever.
- Create a referral process for patients who show warning signs of Dengue Fever.

4. References

1. World Health Organization. Severe dengue. WHO int
2. Fatima, S., et al. Seasonal. Household breeding sites in Lahore. Journal of Public Health.
3. PIMS. Delayed. Severity of Dengue: A retrospective analysis.
4. Riaz, H., & Ahmed, A. Vacan't properties as Aedes reservoirs. Pakistan Journal of Medical Sciences.
5. Malik, S., et al. Obesity as a risk factor for Dengue in pediatric populations. IJID.

APPENDIX: QUESTIONNAIRE FOR INTERVIEWS

1. Patient: When did your fever start and what made you decide to go to the hospital?
2. Lab Technician: At what point in the disease do patients usually come in for a test?
3. Official: What are the biggest challenges you face when it comes to surveillance?
4. Resident: What breeding sites have you seen in your neighborhood?
5. Parent: How do you compare the ways you prevent Dengue Fever at home and, at school?